



Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

EDUCATION SERVICES & SCHOOL ADVANCEMENT · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Education Services

Recovering unpaid service invoices from partner schools — on pure contingency, without damaging the relationship

Prepared for **RedefinED School Advancement** · August 2026

Recovering the invoices your partner schools stopped paying

To the RedefinED team — thank you for reaching out. You told us two partner schools are carrying balances past 90 days on services already delivered. That is the hardest kind of receivable a services firm carries: the work is done, the value has landed, and the relationship makes the follow-up awkward for the very people who are best placed to ask.

An unpaid school invoice is a cash-flow problem, not a relationship problem — until someone on your team has to make it one. A school that has gone quiet on a \$19,000 balance rarely responds to a fourth reminder from the same address, and every month it ages, the leverage and the contact quality both erode.

Southwest Recovery Services is a commercial, B2B-focused outsourced receivables recovery partner working business-to-business balances on **pure contingency since 2004**, with recovery reach across all 50 states. You place accounts through a secure portal that takes your invoice or A/R export, and we work them. No recovery, no fee — and your advancement team never has to be the one chasing.

Two decades of commercial recovery — nationwide

A track record built on business-to-business receivables and a documented, professional process — the follow-up capacity of a full collections department, without adding a seat.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	\$975M+ Receivables placed (all industries)	\$76M+ Recovered for clients	800K+ Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	50 states — nationwide recovery reach	4.9★ Google client rating	\$0 upfront — no recovery, no fee

Commercial & B2B collections since 2004

Nationwide — all 50 states

12 offices across 7 states

Skip tracing on businesses & principals

Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY

FINANCIAL SERVICES
Review

FSR • TOP 10 LIST
2025 Recognition

INTERNATIONAL
Business Times

CFO Tech
Outlook

insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED



 ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

Your questions — answered directly

What matters most when the debtor is also a partner school you intend to keep serving.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — \$0 upfront, no retainer, no monthly minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we actually recover. Commercial contingency scales with the age, balance and volume of what you place; we quote your rate once we see a representative sample. On two accounts totaling roughly \$39,000, there is no cost to placing and no cost if we recover nothing.
2. Protecting the school relationship	This is the first question every services firm asks, so we answer it before pricing. Recovery is handled as a professional business-to-business matter between two organizations — documented, courteous, and escalated in stages. No threats, no misrepresentation, no pressure on individual staff. In practice a third-party letter on agency letterhead changes who at the school is looking at the invoice, and that alone resolves a meaningful share of quiet accounts. If a school comes current and wants to continue with you, nothing in our process prevents that.
3. Balances already past 90 days	Both of your accounts sit in the 61–90 and 90+ bands, so we will be straight about what that means: a 90+ commercial balance recovers at the lower end of our range, not the top. It is still very much workable — institutional debtors have stable addresses, boards, and audited finances, which is why they behave better than most aged consumer paper — but the honest read is that placing at 90 days recovers materially more than placing at 180. We give you an age-based read on your file before anything is worked.
4. Non-responsive schools	The core of what we do: persistent multi-channel outreach, commercial skip tracing to identify the operating entity, the board or diocese behind it, and the finance officer with actual signing authority, and review of legal escalation for accounts that still will not engage. Institutional debtors that ignore a vendor frequently respond once the request reaches the business office rather than the program contact.
5. Onboarding & placement	Fast and low-lift. Bulk-upload an invoice or A/R export through our portal; we map your columns, so there is no re-keying. Send the service agreement and the invoices alongside it — on B2B accounts, the paper is usually decisive. Outreach begins within 24–48 hours of a documented placement, and recovery reach is nationwide across all 50 states, which matters for a partner base spread across PA, FL, VA, TN, TX, CO and beyond.

THE SWRS CLIENT PORTAL**Simple intake and full visibility, on demand**

Every placement is managed through our secure portal — built to take your invoice exports and give a small finance team live, self-service access throughout recovery.

EXPORT-READY PLACEMENT

Upload an invoice or A/R aging export from QuickBooks, Xero or your billing system — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send service agreements, statements of work and invoices safely inside the portal — the documentation that settles a B2B dispute fast.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand — you always know where each school stands.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a school makes directly to RedefinED, so balances stay accurate and no one is contacted after they have paid.

► **Portal Video Tour**

SWRS Commercial Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's commercial book, anonymized by sector and shown at the scale you would actually place. These are professional-services firms recovering unpaid fees from institutional and business customers — the closest structural match to your situation. We show the full spread, including the low end, because a book that is already 90+ belongs nearer the bottom of this range than the top.

ACCOUNTING & TAX

ADVISORY FIRM

Professional services

\$20K recovered

of ~\$20K placed

100% recovered

CYBERSECURITY & ADVISORY

FIRM

Incident response

\$54K recovered

of ~\$58K placed

94% recovered

ARCHITECTURE & DESIGN

PRACTICE

Design services

\$17K recovered

of ~\$19K placed

91% recovered

CREATIVE & MARKETING

SERVICES

Agency services

\$13K recovered

of ~\$23K placed

57% recovered

B2B SOFTWARE &

IMPLEMENTATION

Software services

\$8K recovered

of ~\$25K placed

32% recovered

LEGAL & ADVISORY PRACTICE

Professional services

\$14K recovered

of ~\$45K placed

30% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE AGE CURVE**Why the 90-day mark decides most of the outcome**

A commercial balance is most collectible while it is fresh; every month it ages, the contact who authorized the work moves on, budgets close, and leverage erodes. The highest-leverage change a services firm makes is not chasing harder — it is placing sooner.

WHERE YOUR FILE SITS

Accounts under ~90 days past due often resolve in 30–60 days. Your two balances are already in the 61–90 and 90+ bands, which is workable but sits toward the lower half of the range above.

THE STANDING RULE

A fixed “place at 90 days” policy across all 200+ partner schools recovers materially more than letting balances drift toward write-off — and on contingency there is no cost to placing.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

Cutting the days between delivered and paid

Days Sales Outstanding measures how long delivered work sits as a receivable before it becomes cash. Median DSO runs about 43.5 days and the strongest quartile collects in roughly 25. For a lean advancement firm carrying \$50K–\$250K a month in A/R, every month past that is working capital funding somebody else’s school year.



Schools that have gone quiet

Commercial skip tracing on the institution, its governing board or diocese and its finance officers, plus persistent multi-channel outreach for accounts that stopped responding.



Disputed or contested invoices

Documentation-driven validation — service agreements, scopes of work, deliverable records — that separates a genuine dispute from a budget stall.



Every commercial balance type

Annual program fees, enrollment and admissions retainers, renewal invoices and unbilled overages — one partner, one portal.



Nationwide reach

Recovery across all 50 states from 12 offices in 7 states — built for a partner-school base spread across the country.

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.



AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.



Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.



Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.



Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.



API-first intake

Secure SFTP/API placement means accounts start working without data lag — roughly 50% faster acknowledgment and validation of new placements.



Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that trims DSO and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at the same time. Automation accelerates recovery and standardizes documentation, while empathy-first, data-driven contact protects your brand and keeps disputes and complaints low.

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience



Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, was tapped by Aaron's to train collectors across 100+ locations, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables. Along the way he became convinced the industry's bad reputation was a choice, not a requirement: businesses get paid faster when recovery is built on listening and respect rather than aggressive calls and empty threats.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on that principle — a national, family-owned receivables partner that treats every debtor as a person and every client relationship as worth protecting. Two decades later he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally — an operator who has actually done the job, not a manager who has only overseen it.

Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.

— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.



This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for RedefinED

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The Cost of Waiting: DSO & Commercial Recovery

B2B receivables · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

[Download PDF ↓](#)



The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

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Let's turn those two balances back into cash.

A 30-minute call to walk the two past-due school accounts, confirm the invoice export handoff, and put a contingency rate against them — plus a standing placement rule so the next one never reaches 90 days.

[Book a 30-minute discovery call →](#)

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12 offices across 7 states · nationwide recovery. Private & confidential — prepared for RedefinED School Advancement. FD CPA / CFPB / FCRA compliant · ACA International member.